

Irrigation field guide

1. Watering windows

Watering runs only between four and seven in the morning, when evaporation is lowest.

A bed is watered at most once a day. A second run on the same day is refused.

Where the forecast gives more than five millimetres of rain, the run is skipped.¹

2. Volume per bed

The volume for a bed is its area in square metres times the depth in millimetres set for its crop group.

The depth is four millimetres for leaf crops, six for root crops and nine for fruiting crops.

The volume for one bed is capped at two hundred litres in a single run.

3. Sensors

A bed with a moisture reading above sixty per cent is skipped whatever the schedule says.

Where a sensor has not reported for two days its bed is watered on the schedule alone.

¹ Rain is taken from the forecast issued at midnight, not from the gauge, because the run is planned before dawn.

Annex: how a skipped run is recorded

A skipped run is written to the log with the reason, so that a dry bed can be told from an unwatered one.

The log keeps skipped runs for ninety days.